

Planting styles

Your selection of plants and the way they are grouped convey the style or theme of a garden, be it formal, naturalistic, or traditional. Follow these guidelines to create your chosen design.

NATURAL SWATHES

Contemporary perennial, wildlife, and informal design styles reflect nature by replicating the way plants grow in the wild. Create beds in organic shapes with sweeping, curved edges, avoiding fussy, wiggly lines, and fill them with a restricted number of species, set out in bold flowing swathes. Designers also include smaller pockets of plants within these drifts to mimic the effects of self-seeding. Grasses and perennials, such as yarrow and feather grass (*see below*) are the mainstay of naturalistic schemes, with contrasting flower forms heightening interest.



Natural groups To create a naturalistic design, use a restricted palette of plants, set them out in organic-shaped swathes, and mix perennials and grasses with different shapes and forms to create exciting visual patterns.



Modern blocks Chic and sophisticated, modernist schemes are highly structured with plants grouped in blocks in geometric-shaped beds laid out in an asymmetric pattern. Clipped hedging is popular in these designs.

